

Automated External Defibrillation

Approach safely

Check response

Shout for help

Call 999

Open airway

Check breathing

Attach AED

Follow voice prompts

Descriptions of specific skills

Warning!

These are **practical skills** – you need to be able to **demonstrate** them, not just **describe** them.

They are best learnt in the practical sessions, but if you need a quick reminder, they are described here.

How to use and Automated External Defibrillator

An AED is only for use on patients that are:

- Not responsive
- AND
- Not breathing

It delivers a controlled electric shock to the patient, stopping the heart (and any abnormal rhythm) in the hope that the heart will restart in a normal rhythm.

Attaching the AED

If an AED is needed, it must be attached as soon as it arrives – **stop CPR immediately to do this!**

1. Open the box and switch on the AED
2. Attach the pads
 - a. One pad: on the patient's right chest, *above the nipple, below the collarbone, to the right of the sternum*
 - b. Other pad: on the patient's left side, *over the lateral ribs, below the nipple*
3. Plug the pads into the AED
4. Keep everything and everyone away from the patient whilst the AED

Operating the AED

Follow the instructions given by the AED.

1. **Shock required**
 - a. Clear everyone/everything away from the patient and AED
 - b. Prepare to shock the patient
 - c. As you shock the patient look around to check that nothing is touching the patient
 - i. **Do not look at the button!**
 - d. Immediately restart CPR
2. **No shock required**
 - a. Immediately restart CPR

The AED will re--assess the patient every 2 minutes.

If the AED pads become detached

The AED cannot assess or shock a patient unless both pads are securely attached. In reality, AEDs detect this situation and will prompt you to reattach the pads.

The training AEDs do not do this.

If the pads become detached, you must reconnect them unless the AED has specifically indicated it is not safe to touch the patient.

Special situations

Hairy Patients	Patients with excess chest hair may require removal of this to allow the pads to stick properly: AED kits account for this: - Some include a razor - A spare pad set may be used to 'wax' the required areas
Wet patients	Attempt to dry the patient.
Patients with pacemakers	Normal pad placement avoids the most common pacemaker locations. – <i>Avoid placing pads directly over pacemakers</i> –
Patients with nipple piercing	Normal pad placement should avoid the piercing. <i>Do not waste time removing them.</i>

In all cases, swift defibrillation is essential – *do not waste time!*